



The Hour of His Judgment

Sabbath School Study Notes

Lesson 3

PHASE 4 SDA BRANCH

Revelation 14:7

The Hour of His Judgment

THE FIRST ANGEL'S MESSAGE • LESSON 3 • REVELATION 14:7

Revelation 14:7

What immediately runs through our minds when we think about the hour of His judgment?

Better yet — what is judgment?

1 What Is Judgment?

There are multiple phrases we can use to refer to judgment:

- 1 Decision-making
- 2 Opinion
- 3 Legal system

All of these have a reference to what Revelation 14:7 is trying to speak to. This hour of judgment involves a decision-making, opinion-based legal system.

What is the end goal of the judgment?

To give a verdict as to whether a person is guilty or innocent.

If a person, according to the dictates of modern law, is found guilty — what are they usually guilty of?

- 1 Breaking the law or failing to comply with set rules.
- 2 To verify the claims of the breaking of the law, we also need proof.
- 3 The evidence needs to be weighed by a judge, and a decision would be made.

In the modern judicial system, it is often difficult to prove guilt without evidence.

2 A Biblical Case Study: Genesis 3

Now I want us to borrow an example from the Bible using the modern judicial system.

Genesis 3:1-2

The serpent is asking the woman whether God indeed said that the fruit of the tree should not be consumed.

I want us to place a like-for-like comparison of what God said and what Eve said.

Genesis 2:16-17 (What God said)	Genesis 3:2-3 (What Eve said)
<i>"And the Lord God commanded the man, saying, 'Of every tree of the garden you may freely eat; but of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil you shall not eat, for in the day that you eat of it you shall surely die.'"</i>	<i>"And the woman said to the serpent, 'We may eat the fruit of the trees of the garden; but of the fruit of the tree which is in the midst of the garden, God has said, 'You shall not eat it, nor shall you touch it, lest you die.'"</i>

So Eve correctly says God has said that every tree of the garden may be consumed, which is a reference to Genesis 2:16. Let's take a deeper look at Genesis 3:3 word for word.

Genesis 3:3 (KJV)

"But of the fruit of the tree which is in the midst of the garden, God hath said, Ye shall not eat of it."

Now let's go to Genesis 2:17:

Genesis 2:17 (KJV)

"But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it: for in the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die."

Thus far, what Eve has said is correct. But look at the end of Genesis 3:3 again:

Genesis 3:3 (KJV) — closing words

"Neither shall ye touch it, lest ye die."

KEY OBSERVATION

Eve has introduced something that was not present in the instruction of God — that the tree should not be touched. God said not to eat of it. Eve added to that.

3

The Fall and the Judgment

Now we know what Eve and Adam then did: they ate of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil.

Genesis 3:6-9 (NKJV)

"So when the woman saw that the tree was good for food, that it was pleasant to the eyes, and a tree desirable to make one wise, she took of its fruit and ate. She also gave to her husband with her, and he ate. Then the eyes of both of them were opened, and they knew that they were naked; and they sewed fig leaves together and made themselves coverings. And they heard the sound of the Lord God walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and Adam and his wife hid themselves from the presence of the Lord God among the trees of the garden. Then the Lord God called to Adam and said to him, 'Where are you?'"

It seems like there is a gap between verse 7 and verse 9, where God comes down and seeks their location.

Was God seeking their location to chase them out of the garden?

God was always in communion with Eve and Adam in the garden, and as part of his routine he would come down.

Education, p. 21.1

"Often they were visited by His messengers, the holy angels, and from them received counsel and instruction. Often as they walked in the garden in the cool of the day they heard the voice of God, and face to face held communion with the Eternal."

Is it through our actions that we decide what the purpose of the Lord's coming is?

If Adam and Eve had been obedient, He would not need to ask where they are.

Isaiah 59:1-2**Isaiah 59:1-2 (NKJV)**

"Behold, the Lord's hand is not shortened, that it cannot save; nor His ear heavy, that it cannot hear. But your iniquities have separated you from your God; and your sins have hidden His face from you, so that He will not hear."

Now, through their actions, judgment was passed and as such they were driven from the garden. Do we think judgment would have still occurred if they had not eaten of the tree?

**Revisiting Our Definition**

Let's bring the three parts of our definition back to the garden:

- 1 **Decision-making** — What decision would God have made?
- 2 **Opinion** — Is it right or wrong?
- 3 **Legal system** — What is the output?

Part two will add more to the conversation we had today.

NEXT
WEEK

For next week: What does judgment mean for you?